Guitar Exercises - Section XIV, Level 96

Chart-to-Performance Repertoire Reconstruction

Selective Transcription • Independent Voicing • Style Decisions • Self-Authored Rehearsal Planning

Level 96 of the fixed 105-level core curriculum. HARD STOP after Level 105.

Level 95 supplied a detailed integration path. Level 96 removes much of that support. The student receives incomplete musical information and must decide what needs to be heard, inferred, transcribed, simplified, rehearsed, and performed.

Module	Exercise	Events
A	Lead-sheet reduction and missing-information audit	96
B	Independent form and harmonic-function mapping	112
C	Selective transcription: riffs, fills, and landmarks	144
D	Independent voicing and register decisions	128
E	Style matching from rhythmic evidence	128
F	Self-authored rehearsal plan and risk ranking	96
G	Two partially scaffolded 16-bar repertoire studies	192
H	One minimally scaffolded 24-bar reconstruction	192
I	Forty-eight-bar independent performance capstone	320
J	Post-take diagnosis and next-session planning	64
	TOTAL	1472

Core rule: do not transcribe everything. Transcribe what the performance actually depends on.

Reference - Information Sufficiency for Repertoire

Information	If supplied	If missing
Form	verify landmarks	listen/count sections
Chord symbols	reduce to function	derive bass + quality
Rhythm notation	test against feel	transcribe signature cell
Voicings	evaluate register	choose independently
Riffs/fills	verify	transcribe only structural examples
Dynamics	follow if convincing	derive section arc
Cues	rehearse	identify from recording/ensemble
Ending	verify release	construct clear ending

The player distinguishes essential information from optional detail before touching the difficult passages.

Module A - Lead-Sheet Missing-Information Audit

Prompt	Decision
Chord chart gives C-Am-F-G	What voicings fit the register/style?
Chart says 'shuffle'	What subdivision and note lengths define it?
Slash chord appears	Is bass note structural or optional?
No intro written	Does recording establish a pickup/figure?
No fills written	Which fills are identity-defining?
Repeat signs only	What changes on later repetitions?
Final chord shown	How is the ending actually articulated?
Tempo shown	Does performance feel ahead/on/behind?

Mark each answer: supplied, must transcribe, safe to choose, or safe to omit.

Module B - Independent Form Map

Pass	Deliverable
1	section names or neutral A/B/C labels
2	bar counts
3	first chord of each section
4	last-bar transition chord
5	one rhythmic/melodic landmark
6	dynamic/texture level
7	cue into next section
8	memory map without chord details

The completed form map must fit on half a page. If it does not, it is still too detailed.

Module B - Harmonic Function Map

Task	Example output
Identify tonic centers	C major -> G major
Convert chords to function	I-vi-IV-V
Mark secondary dominants	A7 = V/ii
Mark pivot/common chords	Am7 = vi in C / ii in G where applicable
Mark cadences	ii-V-I / V-i
Mark nonfunctional color	passing diminished / pedal harmony
Mark emergency simplification	root or shell

A chord name is not yet an interpretation. Function predicts where the music is going.

Module C - Selective Transcription Priority

Priority	Transcribe	Usually do not need note-for-note
1	signature riff	routine repeated comping
2	section pickup	every ghost note
3	bass movement that changes harmony	incidental bass embellishment
4	melodic hook	all improvised fills
5	transition figure	every articulation variation
6	ending/cutoff	nonstructural noise/texture

For each excerpt, justify why a detail is structural before spending rehearsal time on exact transcription.

Module C - Eight Selective-Transcription Cards

Card	Given	Student reconstructs
1	chords + tempo	2-bar signature rhythm
2	form + chords	intro pickup
3	chords only	bass inversion in cadence
4	rhythm slash chart	melodic hook
5	verse chart	chorus transition fill
6	full chart	actual ending
7	recording only, 4 bars	roots + signature riff
8	recording only, 8 bars	form + bass + one landmark

Verification: sing/tap first, then locate on guitar, then compare against source.

Module D - Independent Voicing Decisions

Constraint	Choose
Bass line is active	upper triads/shells
Vocal/melody occupies high register	middle voicings
Sparse verse	partial chord with longer duration
Dense chorus	wider voicing or stronger attack, not necessarily more notes
Fast changes	compact nearest inversions
Solo section	reduced shell/guide tones
Modulation	voice-led voicing that exposes destination
Recovery	root + third or root only

Write two viable voicing plans for every section, then choose one after playing with the groove.

Module D - Register Comparison

Pass	Voicing family	Question
1	open/full chords	Does it mask bass/melody?
2	middle triads	Does groove become clearer?
3	upper triads	Does arrangement become too thin?
4	shells	Is harmonic quality still clear?
5	spread/drop voicings	Does section gain useful width?
6	mixed by section	Does form become easier to hear?

The easiest grip is not automatically the best arrangement choice.

Module E - Style Matching from Evidence

Evidence	Inference to test
Long-short eighth spacing	swing/shuffle family
Very short offbeat chords	reggae/ska-type offbeat engine
16th ghosts + short stabs	funk/R&B-type engine
Alternating bass + upper chord	country/Americana-type engine
Muted low pedal + power punctuation	rock/metal riff engine
Sparse upper shells on backbeats	soul/R&B support
Repeated upper syncopated cell	interlocking groove engine
Open space + repeated motif	jam-band conversational pocket

Describe the evidence before naming the style. Then choose the closest learned groove engine and modify it to match the source.

Module E - Style Approximation Ladder

Pass	Goal
1	correct subdivision only
2	correct note length
3	correct accent pattern
4	correct register
5	correct bass/drum relationship
6	correct articulation/ghost hierarchy
7	full performance approximation
8	remove effects; verify feel still survives

Effects may support style, but the groove must remain identifiable without them.

Module F - Self-Authored Rehearsal Plan

Risk score	Meaning	Rehearsal allocation
0	already secure	full-take verification only
1	minor uncertainty	1 focused loop
2	repeatable failure	3 focused loops + transition
3	structural risk	simplify, isolate, rebuild
4	performance blocker	solve before increasing detail

Rank no more than five risks. Do not spend equal time on every measure.

Module F - 30-Minute Rehearsal Budget

Minutes	Default allocation
0-3	form/landmark recall
3-8	highest-risk transition
8-13	highest-risk groove/technique
13-18	second risk
18-23	complete take
23-27	diagnose take; one repair
27-30	final uninterrupted take

The student may alter the allocation, but must write the reason before practice begins.

Module G - Study 1 - Partial chart

Given: | G | D | Em | C | x2, then | Am | C | D | D |. Tempo and section names supplied; groove, voicings, fills, and ending omitted.

Student decisions: choose groove engine, voicing register, one signature fill, transition into B, and ending.

Pass	Deliverable
1	information audit
2	form/harmony map
3	groove approximation
4	selective transcription
5	self-authored rehearsal plan
6	memory performance

Module G - Study 2 - Partial recording brief

Given: 16 bars, tonal center C, chords Cmaj7-A7-Dm7-G7 recur. Exact form and rhythm not supplied.

Student decisions: map form, identify signature rhythm, choose comping voicings, transcribe one hook, and create fallback arrangement.

Pass	Deliverable
1	information audit
2	form/harmony map
3	groove approximation
4	selective transcription
5	self-authored rehearsal plan
6	memory performance

Module H - Minimally Scaffolded 24-Bar Reconstruction

You are given only the following structural facts. All other arrangement decisions are yours.

Fact	Supplied information
Length	24 bars
Tonal centers	A minor, then C major
Required cadence	E7 -> Am occurs before modulation
Required later cadence	Dm7 -> G7 -> Cmaj7
Rhythmic identity	one repeated 2-beat figure must recur
Lead identity	one 4-note motif must recur in 3 registers
Ending	must resolve clearly, not fade

Construct the form, chord sequence, groove, voicings, motif placement, transitions, dynamics, and recovery version. Then perform from memory.

Module I - Forty-Eight-Bar Independent Performance Capstone

Bars	Section	Harmony	Student responsibility
1-4	Intro	Cmaj7-Am7-Dm7-G7	student chooses groove/voicing
5-12	A section	Cmaj7-A7-Dm7-G7 x2	one transcribed/created signature figure
13-16	B section	Am7-Dm7-E7-Am7	minor contrast
17-24	A' section	Cmaj7-Em7-A7-Dm7-G7-Cmaj7-Cmaj7-G7	reharmonized return
25-32	C section	Gmaj7-Em7-Am7-D7 x2	new key-center feel
33-40	Solo/support	Dm7-G7-Cmaj7-A7 x2	student role plan
41-44	Final A	Cmaj7-A7-Dm7-G7	restate signature identity
45-48	Outro	Cmaj7-Fmaj7-G7-Cmaj7	student designs ending

Only the chord/form skeleton is supplied. The student must independently create groove, voicings, register map, fills, expression arc, cue map, fallback arrangement, and rehearsal plan.

Module J - Post-Take Diagnosis

Question	Write one answer only
What was the largest structural error?	
What was the largest groove error?	
Which transition needs isolated rehearsal?	
Which detail was over-rehearsed?	
Which fill/ornament can be removed?	
Which fallback worked?	
What is tomorrow's first 5-minute task?	

Pass Level 96: 14/16 or better on two separate days across form, harmony, groove/style match, selective transcription, voicing decisions, rehearsal planning, memory, and recovery. No zero in form, groove/style match, rehearsal planning, or recovery.

Next: Level 97 moves to recording-led repertoire: reconstructing a complete part from audio with no supplied chord chart, then comparing your functional arrangement against the source.